

FORWARD DEPLOYED AI ENGINEERING

Capstone Project

Stage Five: Revision Log

Recording what your requirements got wrong and why

You are required to revise your requirements document at least once during the build. This is where you record what changed and what prompted the change.

WEEK TWO INTO WEEK THREE · COMPULSORY

Why this is compulsory

A requirements document written before any code exists is a set of educated guesses. Some of those guesses will be wrong, and building is how you find out which ones. A student that reaches the end of three weeks with an unchanged PRD has either been extraordinarily lucky or has stopped consulting the document, and the second is far more common than the first.

This log is not a confession. It is evidence that you were paying attention. The students who score well here are the ones who can point to a specific thing they discovered while building, explain how it contradicted an assumption they had written down, and show what they changed as a result.

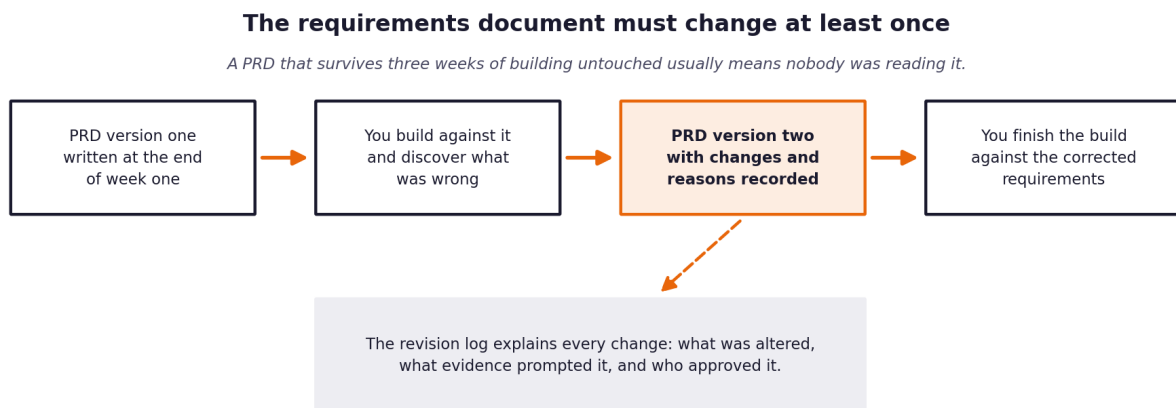


Figure 1. The revision sits in the middle of the build, not at the end.

What a weak revision log looks like

Vague entries such as tidied up wording or clarified requirements tell an assessor nothing. A strong entry names the requirement, states what it said before, states what it says now, identifies the specific thing that prompted the change, and says who agreed to it.

1 Section one: revision summary

Field	Value
New version number	2.0
Date of revision	
Who carried out the revision	
Who reviewed and agreed it	
Number of requirements changed	
Number of requirements added	
Number of requirements removed	

2 Section two: the changes

One row per change. Be specific about the trigger; that column is what distinguishes a considered revision from a tidying exercise.

Requirement ID	What it said in version one	What it says now	What prompted the change	Agreed by

3 Section three: assumptions that turned out to be wrong

Go back to the assumptions section of your version one PRD. For each assumption, say whether it held. The ones that did not are the most interesting part of your report.

Assumption from version one	Did it hold?	What you found instead	What you changed because of it

4 Section four: what you decided not to change

Some things will look wrong during the build and turn out to be right, or right but not worth the cost of changing. Recording those decisions is as valuable as recording the changes.

What looked wrong	Why you left it	What it would have cost to change	Revisit when?

5 Section five: the reflection

Answer these in full sentences. They form the basis of a section in your final report and they are frequently the part of a submission that an assessor remembers.

Question	Your answer
What did you most misunderstand about the problem when you wrote version one?	

Which piece of discovery work would have caught it earlier?	
What would you do differently if you started this project again on Monday?	
What is still uncertain, and what would you need to resolve it?	